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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT MEETS WITKOFF AND KUSHNER

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received the US delegation that participated in the UAE-hosted trilateral talks between Russia and Ukraine, mediated by the US. The delegation included US presidential envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner. The UAE hosted the talks as part of its efforts to promote dialogue and advance diplomatic efforts towards a political solution to the crisis. **SEE ALSO P7**

IN A MAJOR SHIFT, TRUMP SAYS 'WE DON'T NEED DEAL WITH IRAN'

2 supertankers ablaze in Hormuz after explosions

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump declared yesterday that Washington no longer needed a deal with Iran, abruptly casting doubt on peace efforts as two supertankers caught fire in the Strait of Hormuz and oil prices surged.

"We don't need a deal with Iran. Those days have long since passed. We've got their money, Hundreds of Billions of Dollars, and we've got their Strait!" Trump wrote on Truth Social.

Trump directed Vice-President JD Vance to abandon negotiations with Tehran and focus entirely on domestic anti-fraud efforts.

The announcement came shortly after *The Wall Street Journal* reported that Vance was considering face-to-face talks with a senior Iranian security official. Trump had reportedly authorised him to reopen negotiations, making yesterday's declaration a dramatic reversal.

Two supertankers ablaze

Iran's Revolutionary Guards said two supertankers carrying more than four million barrels of oil caught fire following explosions in the Strait of Hormuz.

The Guards claimed the vessels ignored warnings against using an unauthorised shipping route. Iranian media reported they struck naval mines, although this could not be independently verified.

Oil prices rose amid fears of prolonged conflict. Brent crude gained 1.6 per cent to $94.25 a barrel, while US West Texas Intermediate climbed 1.3 per cent to $87.62.

Saudi Arabia intercepts attacks

Meanwhile, the Saudi-led coalition said it intercepted drones over Riyadh and eastern Saudi Arabia yesterday.

It also reported destroying two ballistic missiles targeting western Saudi Arabia and drones over southern Saudi Arabia and the Makkah region on Wednesday, blaming Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis.

Iran threatens wider retaliation

Iran warned that renewed American strikes could trigger attacks on US military installations extending beyond the Middle East.

"If the US launches another war against Iran, every military base involved in the aggression — from West Asia to Europe — will be a legitimate target for Iran's lethal strikes," senior Iranian security figure Mohsen Rezaei wrote on X.

"NO SAFE DISTANCE. NO SAFE HAVEN. NO IMMUNITY," he added.

Iranian military spokesman Abolfazl Shekarchi separately warned that Tehran would retaliate with force ten times greater if Washington launched another attack.

Israel reportedly increased preparations for possible military action against Iran.

Trump's announcement follows sweeping Republican losses in the US midterm elections, partly attributed to public anger over the Iran war and rising fuel prices.

Tehran continues to insist Washington accept its conditions before negotiations can advance, while Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan has urged a return to diplomacy.

Trump's reversal leaves peace prospects uncertain as tensions intensify across the Gulf.

— With inputs from AFP

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DP WORLD FAST-TRACKS DH2.5B FUJAIRAH PORTS

DP World is accelerating its Dh2.5 billion development of two Fujairah ports, bringing forward phased operations to within 18–24 months as the UAE strengthens alternative shipping routes amid Strait of Hormuz disruptions.

Between March and October, DP World moved more than one million TEUs from east coast ports to Jebel Ali and domestic markets by road and rail, using a network of over 3,000 trucks.

Jebel Ali remained operational throughout the crisis, with disruptions limited to six hours. Shipping volumes could recover within one to three months once safe passage resumes.

— Justin Varghese, Your Money Editor

14 killed, 30 injured in Fujairah road accident involving 23 vehicles

Crash involved 18 vehicles, five trucks, as emergency teams continue operations

DUBAI

BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

Fourteen people have been killed and 30 others injured in a major road accident involving 18 vehicles and five trucks in Fujairah, the UAE Ministry of Interior announced.

According to preliminary information released by the ministry, the accident involved a total of 23 vehicles (18 vehicles and 5 trucks).

Medical care

Emergency and specialist teams are continuing field operations to deal with the aftermath of the crash, while the injured are receiving the necessary medical care.

The Ministry of Interior said the relevant authorities were working together to complete on-site procedures and establish the circumstances surrounding the accident.

It added that the situation was being closely monitored and that further official updates would be released once the information had been verified.

The ministry expressed its sincere condolences to the families of those killed, praying for Allah's mercy and forgiveness for the deceased and patience and strength for their loved ones.

It also wished those injured a speedy recovery.

The ministry urged the public to rely on official sources for information and avoid circulating rumours or unverified reports.

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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

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